

rights and/or civil rights expert to the board. (Interestingly enough, there were more votes against it than for it.) You don't have to go to these meetings, but I highly recommend attending one for the sake of it. And yes, they're over Zoom.

Stocks are broken down into a range of categories, but the six most common are as follows:

- **Growth stocks:** These are usually tech companies that are trying to grow quicker than the rest of the stocks in their sector. These are like potential romantic partners that are a bit wild and spontaneous; you don't know what you're going to get and you may crash and burn. High risk with the potential for high reward.
- **Blue chip stocks:** These are the partners your parents want you to end up with. They're established, stable and reliable, with a strong reputation (e.g. Disney stock).
- **Sector stocks:** Stocks can be broken down by sector, such as stocks in healthcare (e.g. pharmacy companies), utilities, IT, energy, pharmaceuticals, materials, financials and consumer discretionary or staples.
- **Large cap stocks:** Market capitalisation is how much a company is worth (e.g. \$1 billion or \$5 billion). Companies that are worth over \$10 billion are large cap. Stocks in large cap companies tend to be more stable, but don't grow as fast (e.g. Alphabet stock).
- **Mid cap stocks:** Companies with a market capitalisation between \$2 and \$10 billion. They're a mixture of the benefits and drawbacks you'd see in both large cap and small cap stocks. The best of both worlds, as Hannah Montana would say.
- **Small cap stocks:** Companies with a market capitalisation of less than \$2 billion. These stocks are the most volatile but can provide high reward for high risk. They're essentially like startups. Most fail but some 'shoot to the moon' and provide great returns.

Stocks can be thought of as the purest form of investing: choosing a company and putting your money on the line to back them.